5

Old Soldiers Never Die . . .

Army Day 2022 was done and dusted. The last Army Day to be held in New Delhi. The DMA had asked us to shift it out of Delhi, but the notice was too short. The heavier equipment, the tanks, APCs, specialist vehicles and guns had already arrived in Delhi. The work on getting them ready for the Army Day Parade had already begun. From my experience as GOC, Delhi Area, I knew what a complex exercise this was. I pointed out to the DMA that Army Day was but a full-dress rehearsal for Republic Day to follow. Even if the Army Day Parade were to be shifted out, the effort for the Republic Day would still be necessary and would amount to a duplication of effort and resultant wasteful expenditure. If the spirit behind this proposal was that the rest of the country too should get a feel of the Army, then that was already happening, through the Colour Presentation Ceremonies, Command Investiture Parades and Army outreach programmes conducted throughout the year pan-India. I had myself presented the Colours on behalf of the President to the Dogra Regiment at their Regimental Centre in Faizabad (UP) and to the Parachute Regiment at Bengaluru.

Copyright © Penguin Random House India
Not for circulation

Four Stars of Destiny.indd 397 11/28/2023 12:45:24 PM